

1. PROBLEM — TWO SETS OF PEOPLE

“Good morning respected jury members.

Our solution addresses **two sets of problems, targeting two important groups of people in our society.**

The first group is the people who need government and cooperative services — especially rural citizens, people with limited digital literacy, cooperative members and farmers.

Their problem is that although information about **government schemes, cooperative services, PACS, crop insurance, financial assistance and grievances** is available, it is often difficult for them to find, understand and access this information.

They may face **language barriers, complicated digital platforms and scattered information sources.**

As a result, they often have to depend on someone else or visit a government or cooperative office even for basic queries.

The second group is the government officers who provide these services.

Officers have to deal with a large number of **repetitive queries** from citizens — explaining schemes, procedures, eligibility, services and grievance processes again and again.

This takes up their valuable time and increases their routine workload, while they could instead focus on cases that require their actual attention and human intervention.

So, we identified a common gap:

On one side, **people need simple and accessible information.**

On the other side, **officers need a way to reduce repetitive informational workload.**

This is the gap we decided to solve with SIA — Smart Indian Assistant.”

2. SOLUTION

“To address these two sets of problems, we developed SIA — Smart Indian Assistant.

SIA is a **multilingual, voice-first AI assistant** designed specifically for rural and cooperative users.

A user can simply **speak or use the touchscreen** to ask their query in their preferred regional language.

For example, a farmer can ask about a government scheme, crop insurance, PACS services or a cooperative-related issue.

Instead of making the user search through multiple portals or understand complicated documents, **SIA brings this information directly to them in a simple and accessible way.**

At the same time, SIA can handle **routine informational queries** and help structure grievances, reducing repetitive workload for government officers.

So, SIA is not designed to replace the officer.

It is designed to assist the officer and empower the citizen.”

3. TECHNICAL APPROACH — HOW SIA WORKS

“Now, let me explain how SIA technically processes a user's query.

First, the user interacts with SIA through **voice or touchscreen**.

If the user speaks, **ASR — Automatic Speech Recognition** converts the voice into text.

The query is then processed by our **AI engine**, where we use **RAG — Retrieval-Augmented Generation**.

Our knowledge base contains relevant **government documents, cooperative information, schemes and legal information**.

Instead of relying only on the general knowledge of an LLM, RAG retrieves the relevant information from our knowledge base and provides it to the **LLM to generate the response**.

We then use **source verification**, so the response is grounded in relevant and trusted information.

Finally, the answer can be provided back to the user as **text or speech using TTS — Text-to-Speech**.

If the user raises a grievance, SIA can also **classify and structure that grievance and route it towards the appropriate channel**.

Our prototype uses a **Raspberry Pi, touchscreen and microphone**, making the system suitable for deployment as a **low-cost kiosk at government offices, PACS centres and cooperative organisations**.

So, our complete technical flow is:

Voice/Touch → ASR → Query Processing → RAG → LLM → Source Verification → Text/Voice Response or Action.”

4. WHAT MAKES SIA DIFFERENT?

“But then, an important question arises — if Google and ChatGPT already exist, why do we need SIA?

Because we are **not building another general-purpose AI assistant.**

We are building a system specifically around the **environment, language and requirements of rural and cooperative users.**

Our system combines:

Multilingual and dialect-aware voice interaction, domain-specific RAG, source-linked responses, grievance classification and proactive scheme notifications.

A user should not have to know complicated government terminology or even know exactly what to search for.

SIA is designed to help them **access, understand, verify and act on relevant information.**

And with proactive notifications, SIA can also keep users informed about **new schemes and important updates**, instead of waiting for the user to know that something exists and search for it.

So, while general search and AI tools provide broad information access, **SIA is designed around the last-mile interaction between citizens and government services.”**

FINAL CLOSING

“Ultimately, our goal is simple:

Make government information easier for people to access, and make government service delivery easier for officers to manage.

That is SIA — Smart Indian Assistant.”